S. HRG. 118–741, PT. 1

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE AUTHORIZATION REQUEST FOR APPROPRIATIONS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2025 AND THE FUTURE YEARS DEFENSE PROGRAM

HEARINGS

BEFORE THE

COMMITTEE ON ARMED SERVICES
UNITED STATES SENATE

ONE HUNDRED EIGHTEENTH CONGRESS

FIRST SESSION

ON

S. 4638

TO AUTHORIZE APPROPRIATIONS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2025 FOR MILITARY ACTIVITIES OF THE DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE AND FOR MILITARY CONSTRUCTION, TO PRESCRIBE MILITARY PERSONNEL STRENGTHS FOR SUCH FISCAL YEAR, AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

PART 1

U.S. STRATEGIC COMMAND AND U.S. SPACE COMMAND
U.S. CENTRAL COMMAND AND U.S. AFRICA COMMAND
U.S. NORTHERN COMMAND AND U.S. SOUTHERN COMMAND
U.S. INDO-PACIFIC COMMAND AND U.S. FORCES KOREA
DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE BUDGET POSTURE
U.S. SPECIAL OPERATIONS COMMAND AND U.S. CYBER COMMAND
U.S. EUROPEAN COMMAND AND U.S. TRANSPORTATION COMMAND
AIR FORCE POSTURE
THE DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY AND NATIONAL NUCLEAR SECURITY ADMINISTRATION ATOMIC ENERGY DEFENSE ACTIVITIES
ARMY POSTURE
NAVY POSTURE

FEBRUARY 29; MARCH 7, 14, 21; APRIL 9, 10, 11, 16, 17, 18; MAY 16, 2024



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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE AUTHORIZATION FOR APPROPRIATIONS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2025 AND THE FUTURE YEARS DEFENSE PROGRAM

THURSDAY, MARCH 14, 2024

UNITED STATES SENATE,
COMMITTEE ON ARMED SERVICES,
Washington, DC.

UNITED STATES NORTHERN COMMAND AND UNITED STATES SOUTHERN COMMAND

The Committee met, pursuant to notice, at 9:30 a.m. in room SH–216, Hart Senate Office Building, Senator Jack Reed (Chairman of the Committee) presiding.

Committee Members present: Senators Reed, Gillibrand, Blumenthal, Hirono, Kaine, King, Peters, Manchin, Rosen, Kelly, Wicker, Fischer, Rounds, Ernst, Scott, Tuberville, Budd, and Schmitt.

OPENING STATEMENT OF SENATOR JACK REED

Chairman REED. Good morning. The Committee meets today to receive testimony from General Gregory Guillot, Commander of U.S. Northern Command and North American Aerospace Defense Command, and General Laura Richardson, Commander of U.S. Southern Command. This is General Guillot's first posture hearing as NORTHCOM commander, and we welcome you, sir. I would also note that this is General Richardson's last appearance before the Committee in her current role. General, I would like to express my appreciation for your decades of admirable service to the Nation, including your outstanding leadership of our SOUTHCOM forces. Thank you very much, ma'am.

I would like to take a moment to acknowledge the ongoing crisis in Haiti. The situation is very concerning, and I understand that United States Military Forces have been deployed to augment security at our embassy in Port-au-Prince and evacuate non-essential personnel. This crisis involves both of your commands to varying degrees, and I would like to know what resources or support you need to respond.

U.S. Northern Command is key to our national security, as the principal command for protecting the American Homeland. Indeed, the first of the four priorities outlined in the National Defense Strategy is, quote, "Defending the Homeland, paced to the growing multi-domain threat posed by the People's Republic of China

by Hurricane Dorian. We launched our missions—my theater of Special Operations Command is at Homestead Air Reserve SOCSOUTH, and we staged our two missions that we conducted into Haiti this past week from Homestead.

So the ability for the Department of Defense to have Homestead as a staging base in South Florida, to be able to jump to respond to humanitarian assistance and disaster response type activities is very hugely helpful.

Senator SCOTT. I thank both of you.

Chairman REED. Thank you, Senator Scott. Senator Kaine, please.

Senator KAINE. Thank you, Mr. Chair, and thanks to our witnesses for your great service. General Guillot, I want to begin with you. My colleagues and I on this Committee have recently discussed installation security with respect to drone threats at bases in the United States. Recognizing that we are in an unclassified setting, what can you tell me about how NORTHCOM is addressing this issue and with what partners are you working this challenge?

General GUILLOT. Senator, NORTHCOM, as part of my 90-day assessment, to tell the truth, the counter-UAS mission has dominated that so far in the first month. Of course, I knew it was an issue, coming from another combatant command where we faced that threat in a very different way because of the environment, but I was not prepared for the number of incursions that I see. I have gone into the events at Joint Base Langley-Eustis, and I am using that as the centerpiece of my 90-day assessment to see where NORAD and NORTHCOM can and should do more as this emerging capability outstrips the operational framework that we have to address it.

Senator KAINE. Can you talk about other partners that you are working with, because obviously there is sort of a law enforcement component of this. So who else is working with you on this problem, sir?

General GUILLOT. Yes, sir, absolutely. So primarily Department of Homeland Security and Department of Justice along the border have the primary responsibility. That is who I am working with there. In the interior it is the services that have the responsibility for defending their bases, so working with each individual service, and then again also Department of Homeland Security and Department of Energy for specific critical infrastructure locations. Those are the primary ones that I am working with.

Senator KAINE. Thank you for that. Now a question for both of you about FMS. The importance of FMS was mentioned by General Kurilla last week. General Guillot, you mentioned it in your written statement. General Richardson, you and I talked about it a little bit last week when we were together. The FMS programs not only increase interoperability and strengthen partnerships but it can help reduce our partners' reliance upon strategic competitors, as well.

What are you hearing from your counterparts about FMS? I want to particularly direct that to General Richardson, recognizing General Guillot's short tenure that has been dominated by other issues. But General Richardson, could you talk about this?

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE AUTHORIZATION FOR APPROPRIATIONS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2025 AND THE FUTURE YEARS DEFENSE PROGRAM

TUESDAY, APRIL 16, 2024

UNITED STATES SENATE,
COMMITTEE ON ARMED SERVICES,
Washington, DC.

AIR FORCE POSTURE

The Committee met, pursuant to notice, at 9 a.m., in room 216, Hart Senate Office Building, Senator Jack Reed (Chairman of the Committee) presiding.

Committee Members present: Senators Reed, Gillibrand, Blumenthal, Kaine, King, Warren, Peters, Manchin, Rosen, Kelly, Fischer, Cotton, Rounds, Ernst, Sullivan, Cramer, Scott, Tuberville, Mullin, Budd, and Schmitt.

OPENING STATEMENT OF SENATOR JACK REED

Chairman REED. Let me bring the hearing to order. For my colleagues' awareness, we intend to conclude today's hearing by 12 noon due to possible floor proceedings, and also the possibility that any one of our colleagues may object to proceeding past 12 noon.

So, this will require us ending the open session at—by 11 a.m. and then moving immediately to a closed session at SVC–217. I ask that Members strictly adhere to the 5-minute timeline, and I will have my gavel to remind people. In that spirit, I will submit my opening statement for the record. Senator Fischer.

Senator FISCHER. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. I would submit my statement for the record as well.

Chairman REED. Thank you very much, Senator Fischer. Let me recognize Secretary Kendall. Mr. Secretary.

STATEMENT OF THE HONORABLE FRANK KENDALL III, SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

Secretary KENDALL. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. Chairman Reed, Senator Fischer, Members of the Committee, General Saltzman, General Allvin, and I thank you for the opportunity to testify today on the Department of the Air Force's fiscal year 2025 budget submission.

The Department of the Air Force budget request supports the National Defense Strategy. We appreciate the Committee's support for the recently enacted fiscal year 2024 budget and your efforts to

threat. There has been a lot of talk about directed energy weapons but overall minimal results. Are you aware of any solutions in development to provide our troops proper force protection against drone incursions?

General SALTZMAN. Yes, we are aware of and are participating in examining several capabilities that may enhance the joint community's defensive capability. Directed energy has high potential for inclusion in counter-drone systems, but there are limitations on currently available technologies. The Air Force is currently spending $13 million for continued development of the Mjolnir weapon. The system will go from a preliminary design review to a critical design review to a fully realized demonstrator. It will be the Department of Defense's first Exportable High Powered Electromagnetic-based Directed-Energy Weapons.

The Department of the Air Force (DAF) works with other Services through the joint Counter-small UAS (C-sUAS) Office to prioritize C-sUAS developmental efforts, including potential directed energy capabilities. The DAF can also defend against Group 3 and larger UAS using fighter aircraft, as recently demonstrated in the Middle East. The DAF is also investing in enhancements to lower-cost munitions, such as 2.75-inch rockets, to provide more affordable air-to-air engagement options.

QUESTIONS SUBMITTED BY SENATOR TOM COTTON

UNMANNED AERIAL SYSTEMS (UAS) AND COUNTER UAS

28. Senator COTTON. Secretary Kendall, three American soldiers were killed at a United States military installation in Jordan by air attack. It is my understanding that many United States forward bases, including the largest in the Middle East, are Air Bases. So, what changes to base protection and defense did the Air Force make after Iranian proxy groups attacked our servicemembers?

Secretary KENDALL. The Air Force has fielded tailored systems-of-systems to seven (7) Air Bases throughout the Middle East that include radars, electronic warfare systems, radio frequency (RF)-based library jamming, library-based detection, and library-based defeat systems.

Additionally, the Air Force deployed a small number of Air Battle Managers to air bases in the United States Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility to support local battle management, airspace deconfliction, and counter-drone operations. The Department of the Air Force is working closely with the Office of the Secretary of Defense, Combatant Commands, and the Services to find and pursue joint solutions that are quickly scalable for forward bases and installations in the Homeland to further fielding efforts.

29. Senator COTTON. General Allvin, public reporting now indicates that Langley Air Force Base Virginia was swarmed by drones for weeks back in December 2023. NORTHCOM Commander, General Guillot, testified in March 2024 that he was still studying this problem. What is the Air Force role in defending Air Bases at home from air attacks?

General ALLVIN. Langley was not attacked, but its airspace was violated by drones. The Air Force, through its Installation Commanders, is responsible for protecting and defending the personnel and assets within our Air Bases. We retain the authority under the Department of Defense's Standing Rules of Force to apply the necessary force to protect those personnel and assets from immediate hostile threats. Additionally, the Department of the Air Force has the role of defending our bases from small-unmanned aircraft system (sUAS) threats at all locations in conjunction with Joint operating doctrine.

30. Senator COTTON. General Allvin, does the Air Force have a validated requirement and sufficient resources to defend bases against drones where we stage stealth fighters and bombers?

General ALLVIN. The Air Force has validated requirements for countering small drones in the 2021 rapid prototyping requirements for counter-small unmanned aircraft systems (C-sUAS) and larger threats in the 2022 strategic requirements document for Air Base Air Defense (ABAD).

As envisioned, this counter small-unmanned aircraft system (sUAS) capability will provide a tailorable, layered defense that, based on risk analysis, may be scaled, to protect a single asset up to and beyond airfield approach and departure corridors, across the full spectrum of the counter-sUAS engagement sequence.

Competing threats and requirements have resulted in stark budgeting decisions that limit the program office to sustaining currently fielded systems only and lim-